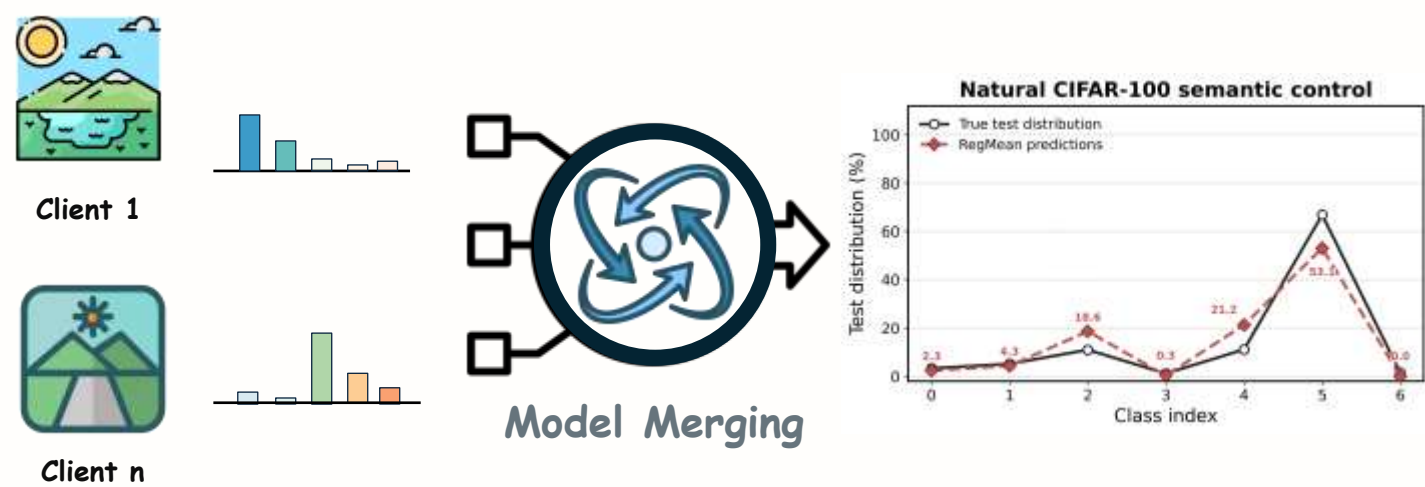
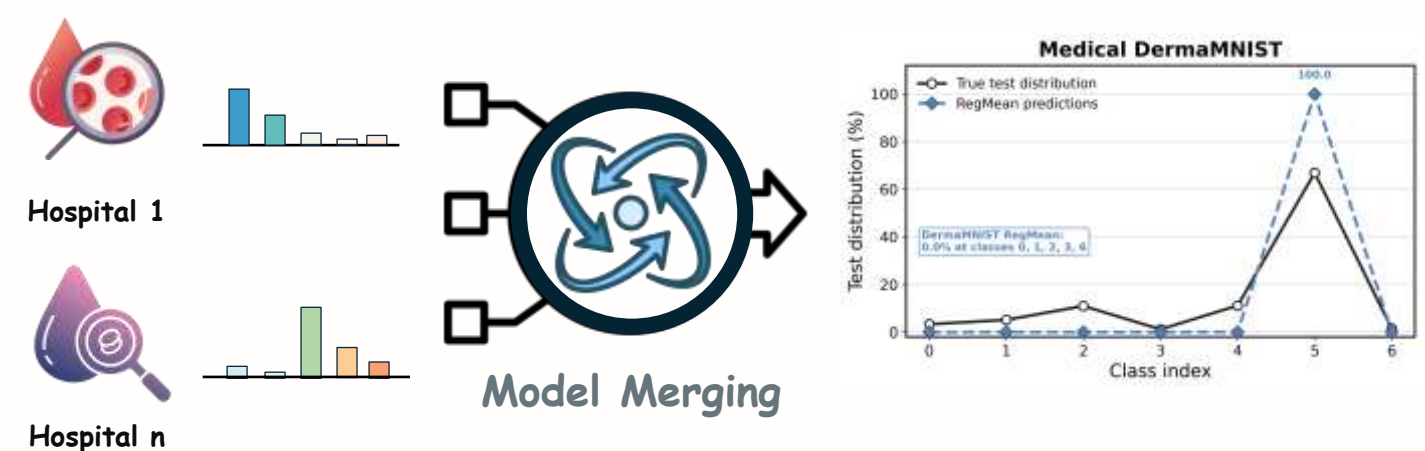


(a) Natural Image Model Merging



Generic visual evidence is broadly shared across isolated natural clients.

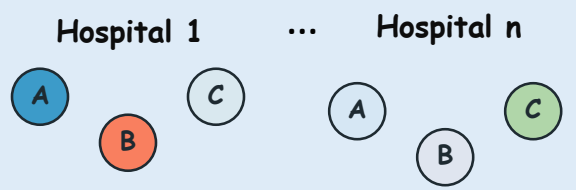
(b) Medical Image Model Merging



Merging partial experts collapses the global prediction.

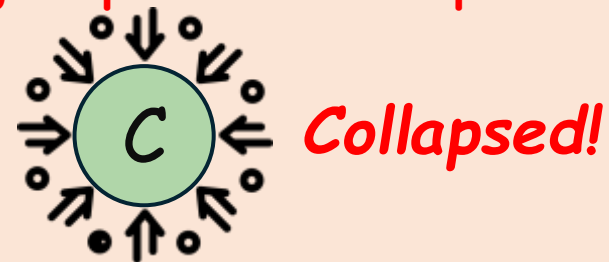
Observation 1: Diagnostic evidence is not shared

Each hospital learns non-overlapping diagnostic features



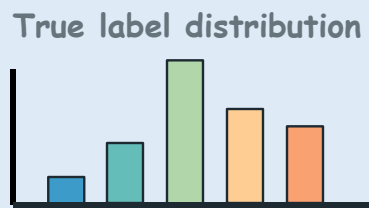
Problem 1: Partial coverage triggers prediction collapse

Most test images are assigned to one dominant diagnosis



Observation 2: Medical images follow a long-tailed distribution

The true medical test set is naturally long-tailed: common diagnoses dominate.



Problem 2: A collapsed model gets a fake-high accuracy

High raw ACC but poor multi-class discrimination

